To address the first assumption: we mentioned already and will say repeatedly, the data mesh is very much focused on making data accessible. And not only accessible, but findable, interoperable, and reusable as well! This accessibility is embedded in one of the four data mesh principles: *data as a product* is all about making sure data is there for the taking.

Completeness of the data is another concern where data mesh shines. Unlike most data warehouse or data lake architectures, data products and their data models are not developed by IT specialists apart from the business. Instead, the development is a joint effort, ensuring the data presented outside the domain is sufficient to derive meaningful conclusions.

The data mesh also helps add value to elements higher in the hierarchy. The teams transforming data into information, knowledge, and wisdom (which businesses like to call *insight*) gain instant access to multiple interoperable data sources.

Of course, in theory, it's possible to make this instant access happen from a data lake as well. However, the reality of a single team managing technical aspects of the environment, as well as data access and transfer rights, in our experience, always makes that infeasible. And if required bits of data are stored in two different data lakes (or four, which is not that unusual), getting them all to work together is next to impossible. In short, having access to read-optimized data products enables quick prototyping of new analytical methods and opens a path for the rapid development of new business capabilities.

THE TECHNOLOGY PERSPECTIVE

The main benefit from the technological perspective is maintaining the speed of development with the organization's growth, as we mentioned previously, which is required to keep generating business benefits from the data. The data mesh is meant to address the shortcomings of other data architectures, like data warehouses or data lakes, by decentralizing data production and governance. Those other architectures introduce a bottleneck—a central team responsible for harmonizing all the data for the whole of your company and making it ready for consumption. A single team cannot scale to accommodate the varied data needs of a growing organization. Both the